DIGITALAIKART · OCTOBER 2026

THE RRB NTPC 2026-27 PLAYBOOK

Graduate + Undergraduate · CEN 06/2026 and CEN 07/2026

Everything the notification does not explain.

5,236	19	60	2026
POSTS IN PLAY	CHAPTERS	PRACTICE Qs	RULES VERIFIED

The RRB-wise vacancy map · the RRB choice that decides your odds · post-preference logic
the A-2 medical filter and the Lasik rule · both CBT papers decoded question by question
real cut-off marks from the last cycle · a dated 12-week plan · 60 practice questions

digitalkartai.shop

Verified against the official CEN 06/2026 and CEN 07/2026 issued by the Railway Recruitment Boards

BEFORE YOU TURN THE PAGE

This book assumes you have a week, not eight months

Two recruitment notifications are open as you read this. One closes on 6 November 2026 and the other on 13 November 2026. Between them they carry 5,236 posts in Indian Railways. Nothing in this book is worth anything if you miss those two dates, so the first chapter is about the form, not the exam.

Most NTPC guides are written for people who have already applied and have a year to prepare. That is not where you are. You are in the last week of an application window, holding a notification that runs to 54 pages and is written in the flat, defensive language of a government document. This book reads that notification for you, tells you which decisions are irreversible, and then builds a preparation plan you can start on Monday.

What is verified and what is my judgement

Every date, fee, vacancy count, pay figure, age limit, medical standard and exam-pattern number in this book comes from the two Centralised Employment Notifications themselves, from the Railway Recruitment Board's unified portal, or from a press release issued by the Press Information Bureau. Where a figure comes from a previous cycle rather than the current one, I say so in the sentence. Where something is my own reading of how the system behaves rather than a rule printed in the notification, I mark it as judgement. The two are not mixed.

> **One thing to check before you rely on any date here**
> This edition was written on 30 October 2026 against CEN 06/2026 and CEN 07/2026 as published. RRBs amend dates, add vacancies and issue corrigenda. Before you act on any deadline, open rrb.indianrailways.gov.in and confirm it. A book cannot replace that check, and this one does not pretend to.

How the chapters are ordered

Chapters 1 to 7 are about the application. They are urgent and they are the ones that decide whether you are in the race at all. Read them this week.

Chapters 8 to 15 are about the two computer-based tests. The CBT dates for both notifications have not been announced yet, which is why the plan in Chapter 18 starts early and stays loose. Chapters 16 and 17 cover what happens after you clear, because the document verification stage eliminates a surprising number of people who did everything else right.

Chapter 19 is sixty practice questions with worked answers. Appendix A is a one-page card you can photograph and keep on your phone. Everything else can wait.

THE TWO NOTIFICATIONS AT A GLANCE

Two open recruitments, one choice

Everything below is from the notifications themselves. If you read nothing else in this book before you apply, read this page and Chapter 7.

	CEN 06/2026 (Graduate)	CEN 07/2026 (Undergraduate)
Posts	3,548	1,688
Qualification	Any degree from a recognised university	Class 12, 50% aggregate
Age on 1 Jan 2027	18 to 33 years	18 to 30 years
Pay levels	Level 6 and Level 5	Level 3 and Level 2
Initial basic pay	Rs. 35,400 and Rs. 29,200	Rs. 21,700 and Rs. 19,900
Medical standards	A-2, B-2 and C-2	B-2, C-2 and A-3
Apply by	6 Nov 2026, 23:59	13 Nov 2026, 23:59
Fee paid by	8 Nov 2026	15 Nov 2026
Corrections	9 to 18 Nov 2026	16 to 25 Nov 2026
Fee	Rs. 500, or Rs. 250 concessional	Rs. 500, or Rs. 250 concessional
Refund on sitting CBT-1	Rs. 400, or the full Rs. 250	Rs. 400, or the full Rs. 250
CBT-1	100 questions, 90 minutes	100 questions, 90 minutes
CBT-2	120 questions, 90 minutes	120 questions, 90 minutes
Typing test	Dispensed with this cycle	Dispensed with this cycle
CBT dates	Not yet announced	Not yet announced
Portal	rrbapply.gov.in	rrbapply.gov.in

Which one is yours

If you do not hold a degree, the answer is CEN 07/2026 and there is nothing to weigh. If you do hold a degree, CEN 06/2026 gives you higher pay levels and a much larger pool of posts, and CEN 07/2026 gives you a smaller field where a Level 3 post is the prize. A graduate with less than 50% in Class 12 is still eligible for CEN 07/2026, because a qualification higher than Class 12 exempts you from the 50% condition.

The one factor that should override the pay comparison is your eyesight. Goods Train Manager, which holds 2,750 of the 3,548 graduate posts, requires medical standard A-2, and A-2 excludes anyone who has had Lasik or any other refractive surgery. If that is you, the graduate notification still offers three posts you can take, but Goods Train Manager is not among them. Chapter 7 explains the standards; Chapter 4 explains what that means for your preference list.

> **The single most expensive mistake available to you today**
> Applying to more than one RRB. The notification states that multiple applications to different RRBs, or to the same RRB twice, will lead to rejection of all of them and to debarment from all future RRB and RRC examinations. One board. One application. Decide before you start the form.

CONTENTS

What is in this book

PART ONE · THE APPLICATION		
1	Two deadlines decide everything, and they are days away	**5**
2	Graduate or undergraduate: your certificate decides, not your ambition	**7**
3	Choosing your RRB is the highest-leverage click on the form	**9**
4	The allotment reads your preference list, not just your score	**12**
5	The application, field by field	**14**
6	Eligibility: the four rules that disqualify people who would have passed	**17**
7	The medical standard is a filter, and Lasik decides it	**19**
PART TWO · THE TWO PAPERS		
8	CBT-1: the 100-question paper, decoded	**21**
9	Normalisation: why your raw score is not your score	**23**
10	CBT-2: 120 questions, and General Awareness is 42% of it	**24**
11	The General Awareness engine	**26**
12	Mathematics: thirteen topics carry the whole paper	**28**
13	Reasoning: six patterns repeat, and speed is the skill	**30**
14	The ninety minutes, hour by hour, minute by minute	**32**
PART THREE · AFTER THE EXAM		
15	The mock system: three hours of repair for every hour of testing	**34**
16	Document verification and the medical: the last three weeks	**36**
17	After the offer: what the job actually is	**38**
18	The twelve-week plan, dated from 2 November 2026	**40**
PART FOUR · PRACTICE AND REFERENCE		
19	Sixty practice questions, with answers and reasons	**42**
A	The one-page action card	**47**
B	Official links and how to verify anything in this book	**48**
C	Glossary	**49**

Chapters 1 to 7 are urgent. Read them before you fill the form. Chapters 8 to 15 are the preparation. Chapters 16 to 18 are what happens after you clear. Chapter 19 is the practice set.

CHAPTER 1

Two deadlines decide everything, and they are days away

You have seven days for the graduate notification and fourteen for the undergraduate one. Everything else in this book is preparation. These seven days are selection.

The Railway Recruitment Boards opened CEN 06/2026 for graduate posts on 8 October 2026 and CEN 07/2026 for undergraduate posts on 15 October 2026. They are separate notifications with separate deadlines, separate eligibility and separate application forms. A candidate who is eligible for both does not get one application covering both; you apply to whichever one you choose, and to one Railway Recruitment Board only.

Milestone	CEN 06/2026 Graduate	CEN 07/2026 Undergraduate
Indicative notice in Employment News	26 September 2026	26 September 2026
Applications open	8 October 2026	15 October 2026
Applications close	6 November 2026, 23:59	13 November 2026, 23:59
Fee payment closes	8 November 2026	15 November 2026
Correction window (Rs. 250 each time)	9 to 18 November 2026	16 to 25 November 2026
CBT-1, CBT-2, Document Verification	Announced later on the RRB portal	Announced later on the RRB portal

What is already fixed, and what you still control

Almost everything in the notification is fixed: the number of posts, the pay levels, the age cut-off date, the exam pattern, the negative marking. Six things are still yours to decide, and each one moves your odds more than an extra month of study would.

1. **Which notification you apply under.** Graduate or undergraduate. This is decided by your certificate, not your confidence, and Chapter 2 walks through it.
2. **Which RRB you choose.** One board, chosen once, frozen forever. Last cycle the general-category cut-off for the same post ranged from 60.48 to 84.16 out of 100 depending on the board. Chapter 3 is entirely about this.
3. **The order of your post and zone preferences.** The allotment reads your list. Omit a post and you have declared yourself unwilling to take it.
4. **Your Aadhaar-seeded bank account.** This is where your fee refund goes. Get it wrong and the money is simply gone.
5. **Which post you put first, given your eyesight.** One post requires unaided 6/9 vision and disqualifies anyone who has had Lasik. Chapter 7.
6. **Your CBT-1 score.** The only one of the six that responds to study.

The three mistakes that end a candidature here

These are not hypothetical. They are printed as rules in the notification, and each carries the same consequence.

- **Applying to more than one RRB.** The notification states that multiple applications to different RRBs, or to the same RRB twice, will lead to rejection of all of them, and to debarment from all future RRB and RRC examinations.
- **Applying while your final result is awaited.** Candidates awaiting the result of the prescribed qualification are not eligible. You must hold the degree or the Class 12 certificate on or before the closing date.
- **Letting the fee lapse.** Submitting the form is not applying. The application closes on 6 or 13 November; the fee closes two days later. An application without the prescribed fee is summarily rejected and the fee is not refunded.

The refund is not a discount, it is a deposit

You pay Rs. 500. If you appear for the first-stage CBT, Rs. 400 comes back to your Aadhaar-seeded bank account, less bank charges. Concession categories pay Rs. 250 and get the full Rs. 250 back. If you do not sit CBT-1, nothing comes back. That is the entire incentive structure: the Railways are charging you for the privilege of being counted, and refunding you for turning up.

CHAPTER 2

Graduate or undergraduate: your certificate decides, not your ambition

CEN 06/2026 needs a degree. CEN 07/2026 needs Class 12 with 50% aggregate. If you hold a degree you may apply to either, and the choice is a real trade-off in pay, competition and eyesight.

The two notifications are not levels of the same exam. They are different jobs with different pay levels, different medical standards and different volumes of competition. Here is every post in both, in one table, with the numbers that matter.

Post	CEN	Level	Initial pay	Medical	Posts
Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor	06	6	Rs. 35,400	B-2	127
Goods Train Manager	06	5	Rs. 29,200	A-2	2,750
Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist	06	5	Rs. 29,200	C-2	300
Senior Clerk cum Typist	06	5	Rs. 29,200	C-2	371
Commercial cum Ticket Clerk	07	3	Rs. 21,700	B-2	700
Junior Clerk cum Typist	07	2	Rs. 19,900	C-2	600
Accounts Clerk cum Typist	07	2	Rs. 19,900	C-2	200
Trains Clerk	07	2	Rs. 19,900	A-3	188

Initial basic pay under the 7th Central Pay Commission. Allowances are paid on top. Source: Annexure A and the vacancy table of CEN 06/2026 and CEN 07/2026.

Goods Train Manager is 77% of the graduate notification

Of the 3,548 graduate posts, 2,750 are Goods Train Manager. Any graduate applying under CEN 06/2026 who does not put Goods Train Manager on their preference list is competing for roughly 800 posts instead of 3,548. That single decision is worth more than most preparation choices, and it is not free: Goods Train Manager carries the strictest medical standard in either notification, A-2, and A-2 is the one that excludes anyone who has had Lasik or any other refractive surgery.

The job itself is running staff work. A Goods Train Manager travels with goods trains, handles the train's documentation, is responsible for the formation and safety of the train, and works shifts that include nights and long absences from home. It is not a desk job and it is not sold as one. What it does offer is a Level 5 post with the largest number of vacancies in the notification, which is why its cut-off is consistently the lowest of the four graduate posts.

Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor is the smallest and the hardest

127 posts across all 21 RRBs, at Level 6 with an initial basic of Rs. 35,400. It is the highest pay level in either notification and the lowest vacancy count, and the combination produces the highest cut-off marks of any NTPC post. Last cycle the general-category CBT-1 cut-off for this post reached 84.16 at RRB Chandigarh. If you put it first, understand that you are putting a long shot at the top of your list, and that the order costs you nothing as long as the posts below it are also on the list.

The two typist posts, and the typing test that is not there this year

Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist and Senior Clerk cum Typist sit at Level 5 with an initial basic of Rs. 29,200 and a C-2 medical standard, which is the most forgiving vision requirement in the graduate notification: 6/12, nil, with or without glasses. For a graduate whose eyesight rules out A-2, these two posts are the realistic path to Level 5 pay.

Both notifications have dispensed with the Computer Based Typing Skill Test for these posts. That is a genuine change from earlier cycles and it is stated plainly in the notification: candidates are still expected to have basic computer proficiency and adequate typing speed, their proficiency will be assessed after joining, and unsatisfactory performance may affect or delay confirmation or promotion. Read that as a promise that the test has moved, not that it has disappeared.

The undergraduate notification, honestly

CEN 07/2026 carries 1,688 posts at Level 3 and Level 2, with an initial basic between Rs. 19,900 and Rs. 21,700. The largest single block is Commercial cum Ticket Clerk at 700 posts, which is also the only Level 3 post in the notification and therefore the most contested. The eligibility rule is Class 12 or equivalent with at least 50% aggregate marks, and the 50% condition is not insisted upon for SC, ST, PwBD and Ex-Servicemen candidates, or for anyone holding a qualification higher than Class 12.

That last exemption matters. A graduate with 45% in Class 12 is eligible for CEN 07/2026, because the degree is a higher qualification. If you are a graduate whose Class 12 marks fall short of 50%, you can still apply under the undergraduate notification.

> **A note on which one to choose**
> If you hold a degree and can meet the A-2 vision standard without surgery, apply under CEN 06/2026 and put Goods Train Manager high on your list. If you hold a degree but your eyesight rules out A-2, CEN 06/2026 still gives you two Level 5 C-2 posts and one Level 6 B-2 post, which is better pay than anything in CEN 07/2026. Choose the undergraduate notification only if you do not hold a degree, or if the graduate cut-offs are out of reach and you would rather compete in a field where a Level 3 post is the prize. That is judgement, not a rule in the notification.

CHAPTER 3

Choosing your RRB is the highest-leverage click on the form

One board, chosen once, impossible to change afterwards. Last cycle the same post had a general-category cut-off of 60.48 at one board and 84.16 at another. That is a 24-mark head start.

When you create an account on rrbapply.gov.in and choose your RRB, that choice is frozen. The notification is explicit that details filled in the Create an Account form and the chosen RRB cannot be modified at any stage, including during the paid correction window. So this is not a field you fill while thinking about something else.

The vacancy map, graduate notification

These are the RRB-wise totals compiled from the Total row of each board in Annexure B of CEN 06/2026. Treat them as indicative and verify against the annexure before you commit, because vacancies are provisional and can be revised.

RRB	Posts	RRB	Posts	RRB	Posts
Bilaspur	542	Bhopal	157	Secunderabad	56
Ranchi	377	Mumbai	155	Gorakhpur	30
Bengaluru	346	Bhubaneswar	146	Patna	29
Kolkata	332	Chennai	141	Malda	26
Ajmer	304	Guwahati	104	Thiruvananthapuram	25
Siliguri	291	Muzaffarpur	78	Ahmedabad	19
Prayagraj	265	Jammu-Srinagar	66		
		Chandigarh	59	All 21 RRBs	3,548

Compiled from the RRB-wise Total rows of Annexure B, CEN 06/2026. Provisional; verify on the official portal.

The cut-off map, last cycle

Vacancies tell you where the work is. Cut-off marks tell you where the competition is not. The table below is the official CBT-1 cut-off for shortlisting to CBT-2 under CEN 05/2024, the previous graduate cycle, whose first-stage test was held in June 2025. Marks are normalised, out of 100.

Read the category numbers carefully. In that cycle, category 1 was Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor, category 2 was Station Master, category 3 was Goods Train Manager, category 4 was Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist and category 5 was Senior Clerk cum Typist. In the current CEN 06/2026 there is no Station Master post and no Traffic Assistant, so the numbering has shifted: 1 is Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor, 2 is Goods Train Manager, 3 is Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist, 4 is Senior Clerk cum Typist. Do not carry the old numbers across.

RRB	Post	UR	OBC	EWS	SC	ST
Chandigarh	1 CCTS	84.16	81.01	81.81	78.16	76.43
Ajmer	1 CCTS	83.01	80.90	77.15	74.11	76.17
Ahmedabad	1 CCTS	80.68	77.87	77.28	73.20	72.73
Mumbai	1 CCTS	80.06	76.47	76.96	73.41	68.53

RRB	Post	UR	OBC	EWS	SC	ST
Secunderabad	1 CCTS	79.76	79.19	78.04	75.15	71.83
Chandigarh	3 GTM	80.85	77.75	78.40	74.69	69.81
Ahmedabad	3 GTM	76.22	74.42	73.84	69.31	67.66
Ajmer	3 GTM	74.38	73.28	70.20	66.76	67.17
Bhopal	3 GTM	73.15	-	70.38	65.39	-
Bilaspur	3 GTM	72.67	70.67	70.44	65.45	60.67
Siliguri	3 GTM	69.36	65.88	56.46	64.70	57.57
Malda	3 GTM	60.48	54.63	42.65	50.84	40.35
Chandigarh	5 SCT	80.56	77.53	77.63	73.99	69.08
Chennai	5 SCT	70.82	69.67	68.11	63.16	56.81
Kolkata	5 SCT	73.44	71.53	71.14	66.80	61.47
Mumbai	5 SCT	71.13	69.66	68.13	65.60	58.59

Source: CBT-1 cut-off notices published by individual RRBs on 19 September 2025 for CEN 05/2024, NTPC Graduate. A dash means the board published no figure for that category. This is a selection of boards and posts, not the complete annexure.

Cut-offs are climbing, and that changes your target

The next cycle, CEN 06/2025, produced higher marks. RRB Bhopal published a CBT-1 cut-off for Goods Train Manager of 80.09 for general category in that cycle, against 73.15 in CEN 05/2024 at the same board. Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor went from 77.89 to 89.56. The reason is mechanical: fewer posts against a candidate pool that has not shrunk. Plan for the higher number, not the average of the last two cycles.

How to actually choose, in five steps

1. **Write down every board whose jurisdiction you would genuinely live in.** Posting follows the board. The notification states that no request for transfer to another railway will be registered until the new appointee completes at least five to ten years of service. Choosing an RRB is choosing where you spend your twenties.
2. **Cross out the boards with almost no posts.** Ahmedabad at 19, Thiruvananthapuram at 25, Malda at 26 and Patna at 29 are not boards you apply to for volume. They are boards you apply to because a low cut-off history makes a small pool winnable.
3. **Check the cut-off history for your post, not the board's average.** Malda's Goods Train Manager cut-off of 60.48 general is 20 marks below Chandigarh's. If Goods Train Manager is your target and you can accept a posting in that jurisdiction, that gap is worth more than a year of extra study.
4. **Check whether you can physically reach the exam centre and the rally or verification venue.** Exam centre choices are limited to five preferences and can be allotted outside them.
5. **Then commit, and stop revisiting it.** You cannot change it, and second-guessing it costs study hours you cannot recover.

The trade nobody explains

A high-vacancy board looks attractive because more posts means a lower cut-off. That is only half true. A high-vacancy board also attracts more applicants, because everyone else can see the same annexure. What reliably lowers a cut-off is a board that is hard to reach, in a jurisdiction most candidates do not want to be posted to. If you are willing to be posted somewhere unpopular, you are being paid for that willingness in marks. Decide whether you are willing, honestly, before you fill the form.

CHAPTER 4

The allotment reads your preference list, not just your score

You pick one RRB. Within that board you rank railway zones, production units and posts. Omit a post and you have declared yourself unwilling to be considered for it.

The notification's language is precise and worth reading twice: candidates can choose only one RRB and indicate their preference for Railway Zones, production units and posts within that chosen RRB only. Candidates with partial options will be considered only for the specific zones, units and posts they opted for, subject to vacancy position at the time of allotment. Where no option is given for a post, it will be considered as their unwillingness for the same. Options once exercised are final.

The practical consequence: a candidate who scores 85 and lists only two posts can lose to a candidate who scores 78 and lists all four. Your list is a second score, and most applicants leave it half-filled because the form makes it feel like an afterthought.

How allotment actually works

1. CBT-1 is screening. The notification calls it screening in nature. Its normalised score is used only to shortlist for CBT-2.
2. CBT-2 shortlisting is at 15 times the community-wise vacancies in your RRB. That is generous. Most people who sit CBT-1 and clear the qualifying mark still do not make this cut.
3. Document Verification shortlisting is at 1:1 against vacancies, on merit from CBT-2. This is the stage where your preference list starts to bind.
4. Post and zone allotment happens after DV and medical, by merit, then preference, then vacancy availability at the moment the panel is drawn.
5. Once empanelled, you forfeit the right to be considered for any other post or category in the same pay level.

The ordering rule that actually works

Most candidates order by prestige: the highest pay level first, then descending. That is the wrong rule for two reasons. First, it ignores the medical filter, and a post you cannot pass the medical for is not a post you were ever competing for. Second, it ignores the fact that being empanelled for a lower post is worth infinitely more than being rejected for a higher one.

Order by a single question applied to each post: *if this were the only post I was offered, would I take it and move?* If yes, it goes above everything you would hesitate on. If no, leave it off entirely. A half-hearted post on your list is a post you may be allotted and then resent for the next five years, because you cannot request a transfer out of it.

> **The A-2 trap, stated plainly**
> If you list Goods Train Manager and you fail the A-2 medical standard at the medical examination, the notification states that you will not be given any alternative appointment. You are not downgraded to a C-2 post lower on your list. You are out. If your unaided distance vision is borderline, or if you have had Lasik, put the C-2 posts above Goods Train Manager rather than below it. This one ordering decision has ended more candidatures than any other in this recruitment.

Three preference lists, for three real situations

Profile A: graduate, unaided vision 6/6 both eyes, no surgery, willing to travel

Order: Goods Train Manager, Senior Clerk cum Typist, Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist, Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor. Goods Train Manager first because it holds 2,750 of the 3,548 posts and has the lowest cut-off of the four; the two Level 5 C-2 posts next because they pay the same as Goods Train Manager without the medical risk; the Level 6 post last, as a free lottery ticket.

Profile B: graduate, wears glasses, no surgery

Order: Senior Clerk cum Typist, Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist, Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor. Leave Goods Train Manager off. A-2 requires 6/9 and 6/9 distant vision without glasses and adds tests for colour, binocular, night and myopic vision. If you cannot read the sixth line unaided, listing it is not optimism, it is a route to disqualification.

Profile C: graduate who has had Lasik

Order: Senior Clerk cum Typist, Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist, Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor. Lasik is explicitly not eligible for A-2. It is eligible for B-2 and C-2 under the Railway Board letter attached to the notification as Annexure VII(A). Chapter 7 covers this in detail, but the ordering consequence belongs here: Goods Train Manager is closed to you and no amount of preference-list cleverness reopens it.

One more thing about zones

Within your chosen RRB you also rank Railway Zones and production units. This is where you decide between a big city and a district headquarters, and the notification gives you no help: allotment is subject to merit and vacancy position, and the board reserves the right to allot a zone you did not opt for if it considers that in administrative interest. Fill every zone you would accept. An empty zone list is not neutral; it is a smaller set of outcomes.

CHAPTER 5

The application, field by field

The form takes about forty minutes if nothing goes wrong. Here is what goes wrong.

Create an Account is the irreversible part

Before you can apply, you create an account on the unified portal with a mobile number and an email address. Those two fields, and the RRB you choose, cannot be modified afterwards by any route, including the paid correction window. Use a mobile number you will still hold in two years, and an email address you actually open, because every subsequent communication from the board arrives there.

If you have applied to any RRB notification in 2024, 2025 or 2026, you already have an account. Do not create a second one. Log in with the same credentials. Candidates who create duplicate accounts run into verification problems that no helpline resolves quickly.

The Aadhaar-seeded bank account

Your fee refund goes only to a bank account seeded with your Aadhaar number. During the application you validate your Aadhaar, and the portal shows the account already linked to it for you to confirm. If no account is linked, you are redirected to the NPCI portal to link one in real time and then returned to the form. If you do not hold a bank account, the notification allows a family member's Aadhaar-seeded account under the same procedure.

The notification places the entire responsibility for this on you: the board will not entertain correspondence or claims arising from an incorrect, invalid or non-operational account. Do this check before you start the form, not after.

Photograph and signature

The signature specification is unusually precise and it is a common rejection point. Scanned signature: minimum 100 DPI, minimum 140 pixels wide by 60 pixels high, file size between 30 KB and 49 KB, JPG or JPEG. The signature must sit inside the designated box on the form, which is 35 mm wide by 20 mm high. A photograph that does not match your face at the centre means you are not permitted to sit the test, so upload a recent one, not a five-year-old studio print.

Fee and refund

Category	Fee	Refund on appearing in CBT-1
All candidates not listed below	Rs. 500	Rs. 400, less bank charges
SC, ST, Ex-Servicemen, PwBD, Female, Transgender, Minorities, EBC	Rs. 250	Rs. 250, less bank charges

Payment is online only: internet banking, debit card, credit card or UPI. Service charges are borne by you. There is no offline option and no cash option.

EBC is not OBC and not EWS

The notification carries an explicit caution about this, which means people get it wrong every cycle. Economically Backward Class, Economically Weaker Section and Other Backward Class are three distinct categories. EBC is defined by annual family income below Rs. 50,000, evidenced by an EBC certificate, a BPL card or an Izzat MST issued by the Railways. It gives you a fee concession and nothing else. There is no reservation of posts for EBC candidates. If you claim it, you must produce the original at document verification or your candidature is liable to be rejected.

Minority candidates claiming the fee waiver must furnish an affidavit in the prescribed form on non-judicial stamp paper at document verification. Minorities are defined in the notification as Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains and Zoroastrians (Parsis).

Fourteen ways this application gets rejected

- Applying to more than one RRB, or twice to the same RRB.
- Awaiting your final degree or Class 12 result on the closing date.
- Date of birth that does not match your Class 10 certificate, to the day.
- Name spelt differently from your Class 10 certificate without recording the change.
- Photograph that does not match your face at the centre.
- Signature outside the specified pixel dimensions or file size.
- Fee not paid by the fee deadline, two days after the application deadline.
- Aadhaar-seeded bank account missing, invalid or non-operational, so the refund fails.
- Community or category status not held on the closing date.
- Caste certificate in the wrong format or not valid on the closing date.
- PwBD certificate dated after the closing date of the application.
- Age outside the window for the post you opted for, after the correct single relaxation.
- Opting for a post whose medical standard you cannot meet.
- Leaving the post or zone preference list partly empty and then expecting allotment.

The correction window, and what it cannot fix

After the application closes there is a paid window: 9 to 18 November 2026 for the graduate notification, 16 to 25 November 2026 for the undergraduate one. Corrections cost Rs. 250 per occasion and that fee is not refundable. You can correct most fields. You cannot correct the Create an Account details, including mobile number and email, and you cannot change the RRB. After 18 November, for the graduate notification, no representation for modification will be entertained at all.

Documents to assemble this week, not next month

Class 10 certificate or mark sheet for date of birth; degree certificate or Class 12 certificate with its date of issue; consolidated marksheet showing the date the final result was declared; caste or community certificate in the prescribed format; EWS certificate if applicable; PwBD certificate if applicable; Ex-Servicemen employment certificate with probable date of discharge if serving; EBC certificate, BPL card or Izzat MST if claiming the fee concession; minority affidavit if claiming the fee waiver. Every one of these is asked for at document verification, and each has a date condition tied to the closing date of the application.

CHAPTER 6

Eligibility: the four rules that disqualify people who would have passed

None of these four is hard to satisfy. All four are easy to get wrong, and none can be fixed after the closing date.

Rule one: age is counted on 1 January 2027, not today

Both notifications fix the same reference date. Graduate posts under CEN 06/2026 carry a base age band of 18 to 33 years. Undergraduate posts under CEN 07/2026 carry 18 to 30 years. The date of birth you enter must match your Class 10 certificate exactly, and no subsequent request for a change of date of birth is considered. Any difference leads to disqualification.

Category	CEN 07/2026: born not before	Born not after
UR and EWS	2 January 1997	1 January 2009
OBC-NCL (+3 years)	2 January 1994	1 January 2009
SC and ST (+5 years)	2 January 1992	1 January 2009

Both dates inclusive. These windows apply before any other eligible relaxation. Source: CEN 07/2026, para 5.2.

Rule two: you take the highest relaxation, never the sum

This is the most misread rule in the notification. Relaxations do not stack. If you qualify on more than one ground you get the highest single relaxation. The published relaxations include three years for OBC-NCL, five for SC and ST, ten years for PwBD (thirteen with OBC-NCL, fifteen with SC and ST), three, six or eight years for Ex-Servicemen after deducting the period of service, up to forty, forty-three or forty-five years for serving Group C and erstwhile Group D railway staff with three years of service, and up to thirty-five, thirty-eight or forty for widowed, divorced or judicially separated women who have not remarried.

Note the corollary the notification states explicitly: SC, ST and OBC candidates applying against unreserved vacancies get no age relaxation. If you apply against a UR vacancy, you are competing on the UR age band.

Rule three: you must hold the qualification on the closing date

Candidates awaiting the final result of the prescribed qualification are not eligible. That is the notification's own sentence, in capitals in some printings. If your degree result is due in December 2026, you cannot apply in November 2026. You apply next cycle.

There is a narrow relief for certificates rather than results. If the certificate was issued after the closing date, the consolidated marksheet showing the date the final qualifying examination result was declared, or the individual semester mark sheets with their declaration dates, will establish that you held the qualification in time. If none of your documents carries a date, you need a certificate from the institute or board confirming when the result was declared. Arrange that now if it applies to you.

Rule four: the 50% aggregate rule and its four exemptions

For CEN 07/2026 the qualification is Class 12 or equivalent with not less than 50% marks in the aggregate. The 50% condition is not insisted upon for SC, ST, PwBD and Ex-Servicemen candidates, or for candidates holding a qualification higher than Class 12. There is no percentage requirement at all in CEN 06/2026 beyond holding a degree from a recognised university or its equivalent.

The one-minute eligibility test

Hold the certificate the notification asks for, on the closing date? Date of birth inside the band after applying the single highest relaxation? Community status held on the closing date, with the certificate to prove it? If all three are yes, you are eligible and the rest of this book applies to you. If any one is no, stop and re-read the notification before spending Rs. 500.

Two smaller rules people forget

First, only unmarried status is relevant in the Agniveer recruitment, not here, but the equivalent trap in NTPC is the ex-serviceman route: a serving member of the armed forces must submit an employment certificate with the probable date of discharge, valid as on the closing date, and a self-declaration at document verification. Second, candidates who already secured civil employment under the central government in Group C or erstwhile Group D after using ex-serviceman benefits are not eligible for those benefits again.

CHAPTER 7

The medical standard is a filter, and Lasik decides it

Four medical standards appear across the two notifications. One of them excludes anyone who has had refractive surgery, and it happens to be attached to 77% of the graduate posts.

Medical fitness is checked at the end, after document verification, by a railway medical authority. It is not a formality. The notification states that candidates found medically unsuitable for the opted post will not be given any alternative appointment. That sentence is the reason this chapter exists before the exam chapters.

Standard	Posts	Distant vision	Other requirements
A-2	Goods Train Manager	6/9, 6/9 without glasses; no fogging test	Colour vision, binocular vision, night vision and myopic vision tests
B-2	Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor; Commercial cum Ticket Clerk	6/9, 6/12 with or without glasses, lens power not above 4D	Near vision Sn 0.6, 0.6; field of vision and binocular vision tests
C-2	Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist; Senior Clerk cum Typist; Junior Clerk cum Typist; Accounts Clerk cum Typist	6/12, nil, with or without glasses	Near vision Sn 0.6 combined, where reading or close work is required
A-3	Trains Clerk	As prescribed for the post in Annexure A	Refer to the notification

Source: Standards of Medical Fitness, CEN 06/2026 and CEN 07/2026. The standards are indicative, not exhaustive. The governing text is Chapter 5 of the Indian Railway Medical Manual, Volume I.

The Lasik rule, exactly

Candidates who have undergone Lasik surgery or any other surgical procedure to correct refractive error are not eligible for a post with medical standard A-2 in this notification. They are eligible for posts with medical standard B-2 and C-2, subject to the conditions in the Railway Board letter dated 25 August 2022, which is attached to the notification as Annexure VII(A).

In plain terms: if you have had Lasik, Goods Train Manager is closed to you and the other three graduate posts are open. If you are considering Lasik and also considering this recruitment, the order of those two decisions matters enormously and only you can weigh it. I am not going to pretend that is a neutral choice.

What to do this week

1. Get a refraction test. Any optician will do it in ten minutes for a few hundred rupees, and it gives you your unaided distance vision in the 6/9, 6/12 notation the notification uses.
2. If your unaided vision reads 6/9 or better in both eyes, A-2 is open to you and Goods Train Manager can go at the top of your list.
3. If it reads 6/12 or worse, do not list an A-2 post. List the C-2 posts, where 6/12 with or without glasses is the requirement.
4. If you have had any refractive surgery, list only B-2 and C-2 posts and carry the operative records to the medical examination.
5. If you have a colour vision deficiency, check it now. Several of these posts require colour vision tests and there is no appeal against a genuine colour vision failure.

If you fail the medical

There is one route. A candidate who fails to acquire the required standard at the initial medical examination may be offered one last and final opportunity to prefer a medical appeal on payment of prescribed charges, with conditions laid down. If you avail the appeal within the allowed time, the appeal result is final and binding. If you do not avail it in time, the initial examination result stands. Diopters, if you are borderline, can shift; colour vision generally does not.

> **The cheapest insurance in this entire process**
> A refraction test costs less than the application fee. It tells you which of the eight posts you are actually eligible for, which decides your preference list, which decides whether you get appointed at all. Do it before you fill the form, not after the medical examination.

CHAPTER 8

CBT-1: the 100-question paper, decoded

Ninety minutes, one hundred questions, and fifty-four seconds per question. The paper is not hard. It is fast, and speed is a skill you can build in eight weeks.

Section	Questions	Marks	Share of paper
General Awareness	40	40	40%
Mathematics	30	30	30%
General Intelligence and Reasoning	30	30	30%
Total	100	100	90 minutes

Each question carries one mark. One third of a mark is deducted for every wrong answer. Candidates eligible for a scribe get 120 minutes. Source: CEN 06/2026, para 13.1.

The notification calls CBT-1 screening in nature, and says the standard of questions will be generally in conformity with the educational standards prescribed for the posts. For the graduate notification that means degree-level reasoning applied to Class 10-level content. The syllabus list is explicit that General Science runs up to Class 10 CBSE. Nothing in CBT-1 requires a graduate's subject knowledge.

The qualifying mark is not the cut-off

Two different numbers decide two different things, and candidates conflate them constantly.

Category	Minimum qualifying marks	What it means
UR	40%	Score below 40 and you are out regardless of vacancies
EWS	40%	Same floor
OBC-NCL	30%	Same floor
SC	30%	Same floor
ST	25%	Same floor

The qualifying mark gets you considered. The cut-off gets you shortlisted, and the cut-off is set by the marks of the people who applied to your board, for your post, in your category. That is why Chapter 3's cut-off table matters more than any target score anyone quotes you. There is a two-mark relaxation for PwBD candidates where there is a shortage against reserved vacancies.

The negative marking arithmetic, done properly

One third negative means a wrong answer costs 0.33 marks and a right answer earns 1.00. That changes what a guess is worth, and the answer is not the same for every guess.

Your situation	Chance of being right	Expected value per attempt
You know the answer	1.00	+1.00
You eliminate three options	1.00	+1.00
You eliminate two options (a 50-50)	0.50	+0.33
You eliminate one option	0.33	+0.11
You eliminate nothing (blind guess)	0.25	0.00

The last row is the one people get wrong in both directions. A blind guess is worth exactly zero in expectation, so it neither helps nor hurts your score, and it costs you time you could spend on a question you can solve. A 50-50 is worth a third of a mark every single time you take it. Leaving a 50-50 blank is the most expensive habit in this exam.

What an attempt pattern is actually worth

Here is the arithmetic behind the advice to attempt aggressively. Assume 100 questions, that you are certain of the first group, that you narrow the second group to two options and then guess, and that you leave the rest.

Certain	50-50 guesses	Left blank	Expected score
70	0	30	70.0
65	20	15	71.7
55	30	15	65.0
45	40	15	58.3
55	30 blind	15	55.0

Two things fall out of that table. First, a candidate certain of 65 who also works 20 questions down to a 50-50 beats a candidate certain of 70 who attempts nothing extra. Second, converting those 30 guesses from blind to 50-50 is worth ten marks, which is the difference between shortlisting and not in most boards. Working a question down to two options is a scoring skill, not a warm-up.

Time budget for ninety minutes

Block	Minutes	Seconds per question	Why
General Awareness, 40 questions	22	33	You either know it or you do not. Reading it twice never helps.
Reasoning, 30 questions	33	66	Puzzles reward a settled method, not speed.
Mathematics, 30 questions	35	70	Calculation time is real and cannot be rushed safely.
Total	90		

General Awareness first, always. It is the only section where a second look adds nothing, so it is the section you should finish fastest and leave. Doing it first also means a slow mathematics section cannot eat the marks you already knew.

The three-pass method

Pass one, about 40 minutes: read every question once and answer only what you are certain of. Mark everything else for review. Pass two, about 35 minutes: return to the marked questions and work each one down to a 50-50 or better, then answer. Pass three, the last 15 minutes: sweep the remaining blind guesses and the questions you have not read at all. Answer every 50-50 you can find, and answer blind guesses only where you have nothing better to do with the minute.

CHAPTER 9

Normalisation: why your raw score is not your score

The paper you sit is not the paper everyone sat. The board adjusts for that, and the adjustment moves your marks in ways you cannot predict.

Both notifications state that normalisation of marks will be done for the CBTs held in multiple shifts, and that the normalised score of the first-stage CBT is what is used to shortlist for the second stage. The exact formula is not printed in the Centralised Employment Notification. What follows is how normalisation works in general and what it means for how you should prepare. Treat the mechanism as description, not as the board's published method.

The idea in one paragraph

When an exam runs across several days and shifts, some question papers are harder than others. If raw marks were compared directly, a candidate who sat a hard shift would be penalised for something outside their control. Normalisation rescales each shift's marks so that candidates are compared on where they stand within their own shift rather than on the raw number they scored. A candidate at the 90th percentile of a hard shift ends up with a comparable normalised score to a candidate at the 90th percentile of an easy one.

What follows for you

1. **Stop chasing a raw target.** 'I need 75 out of 100' is not a meaningful goal when the same raw 75 can normalise to 68 in an easy shift and 82 in a hard one. Chase a percentile, and use the cut-off table in Chapter 3 as your benchmark, because those figures are already normalised.
2. **A hard paper is not bad luck.** If your shift's paper is brutal, everyone in it is being measured against the same brutal paper. What hurts is being average in an easy shift, not being average in a hard one.
3. **Do not compare your mock scores to someone else's.** Unless you sat the same paper in the same sitting, the comparison is meaningless. Compare your score to your own previous score on the same test series.
4. **Accuracy beats reach.** Because normalisation compresses differences at the top and stretches them in the middle, the candidates who move up are the ones with fewer careless errors, not the ones who attempted the most questions.

> **One practical consequence people miss**
> Because your CBT-1 mark is only used to shortlist for CBT-2, and that shortlist is at fifteen times the vacancies, CBT-1 is a threshold exam, not a ranking exam. You do not need to top it. You need to clear it comfortably. That is an argument for spending your last two weeks before CBT-1 on your weakest section rather than polishing your strongest one.

CHAPTER 10

CBT-2: 120 questions, and General Awareness is 42% of it

The second paper is where the post is actually won. Its weight has shifted further towards General Awareness, and that is the single most useful fact in this book.

Section	CBT-1	CBT-2	Change
General Awareness	40	50	Up 10
Mathematics	30	35	Up 5
General Intelligence and Reasoning	30	35	Up 5
Total questions	100	120	Up 20
Duration	90 minutes	90 minutes	Same

Both papers carry one mark per question with one third negative marking. Candidates eligible for a scribe get 120 minutes in each. Source: CEN 06/2026, paras 13.1 and 13.2.1.

General Awareness goes from 40% to 41.7% of the paper, Mathematics and Reasoning from 30% each to 29.2% each. That looks like a rounding difference. It is not, when you consider what it costs to gain a mark in each section. A General Awareness mark costs you the time to recall a fact. A Mathematics mark costs you the time to compute. Moving the paper's weight towards the cheaper section means the second paper rewards breadth over depth.

CBT-2 is also faster per question

One hundred and twenty questions in ninety minutes is forty-five seconds per question, against fifty-four in CBT-1. You have to be quicker on a paper with more content in it. The time budget that works:

Block	Minutes	Seconds per question
General Awareness, 50 questions	26	31
Reasoning, 35 questions	30	51
Mathematics, 35 questions	34	58
Total	90	

The two ratios that define the whole recruitment

Shortlisting for CBT-2 is at fifteen times the community-wise vacancies of the posts notified against your RRB. Shortlisting for document verification is at one times the vacancies. So of the fifteen people who reach CBT-2 for every post, fourteen will not be appointed. CBT-1 is a qualifier; CBT-2 is the selection. Every hour you spend after CBT-1 should be spent on CBT-2's shape, which means a heavier General Awareness load and faster reasoning.

There is one more consequence worth internalising. Because CBT-2 shortlisting is by normalised merit against community-wise vacancies within your board, and because your preference list binds from that point, the candidate who prepared the second paper well and listed every post they would accept will beat a better-prepared candidate who listed two posts and hoped.

What changes between the two papers, in practice

Between CBT-1 and CBT-2, do not revise the same material harder. Add breadth to General Awareness and add speed to Reasoning. Your Mathematics ceiling is set by the topics you know, and eight weeks does not move it much. Your General Awareness ceiling is set by how many months of current affairs you have consolidated, and eight weeks moves that a great deal.

CHAPTER 11

The General Awareness engine

Ninety of the two hundred and twenty marks across both papers sit in one section. It is also the section you can build fastest, because it rewards coverage rather than talent.

The notification prints the General Awareness syllabus in one dense paragraph. Read it as a list of sources rather than a list of topics, and it becomes a plan.

The official syllabus, grouped

Bucket	What the notification lists	Where to read it
Current events	Current events of national and international importance; games and sports	Your own monthly digest, twelve months back from the exam
Polity	Indian polity and governance: Constitution and political system; important government and public sector organisations of India; flagship government programmes	NCERT Class 6 to 10 Social Science, then one standard polity textbook
History	History of India and freedom struggle; art and culture of India; Indian literature; monuments and places of India; famous personalities of India and the world	NCERT Class 6 to 10 History; a one-page timeline of the freedom struggle
Geography	Physical, social and economic geography of India and the world; flora and fauna of India	NCERT Class 6 to 10 Geography
Science	General science and life science up to Class 10 CBSE; general scientific and technological developments, including India's space and nuclear programme	NCERT Class 6 to 10 Science; ISRO and DAE press releases
Economy and systems	Indian economy; transport systems in India; basics of computers and computer applications; common abbreviations; UN and other important world organisations; environmental issues	NCERT Economics; one page each on UN, WHO, IMF, World Bank, WTO

Grouped from the syllabus paragraph in CEN 06/2026, para 13.1(b). The notification's own wording is preserved in the middle column.

The railways-specific block nobody mentions

The syllabus includes transport systems in India, and the exam is conducted by the Railway Recruitment Boards for the Ministry of Railways. Questions on railway zones, their headquarters, production units and what each unit manufactures appear often enough that the block is worth a single dedicated page in your notes. Build it from the official Indian Railways website rather than from a coaching handout, because zone boundaries have been redrawn and old notes are wrong.

How to build current affairs in ten weeks

1. **Fix your window.** Take the twelve months before your expected CBT date. Because the CBT dates have not been announced, start with the twelve months before today and keep rolling forward.
2. **Work backwards, monthly.** Take one month at a time and write a single page: five national events, three international, two sports, two awards, three appointments, two schemes launched.
3. **Use one source per month, not five.** Pick one and finish it. Reading four half-summaries of the same month is how people spend ten weeks and remember nothing.

4. **Test the page, do not re-read it.** Turn each page into eight one-line questions and answer them a week later. Retrieval is what sticks; re-reading is what feels like work.
5. **Add static General Awareness in parallel, at twenty minutes a day.** Current affairs is unbounded and static is finite. Finish the finite part first.

Where the marks actually leak

In a 40-question General Awareness section, most candidates can answer between 18 and 24 with confidence. The gap between a candidate who scores 22 and one who scores 31 is almost never the obscure fact. It is the ordinary fact they half-remember and then doubt: which article, which amendment, which river, which year. Doubt converts a correct answer into a blank or a wrong one. That is why the static block is worth more than the current affairs block, and why a one-page summary you can recite beats a folder you have read once.

> **The twenty-minute daily rule**
> Twenty minutes a day on static General Awareness, six days a week, for ten weeks, is twenty hours. That is enough to cover NCERT Class 6 to 10 Science, History, Geography and Civics once, properly, if you read for understanding rather than for completion. Most candidates never do this and then wonder why their General Awareness score plateaus at 20.

CHAPTER 12

Mathematics: thirteen topics carry the whole paper

The syllabus is short and entirely predictable. It is also arithmetic-heavy, which means the marks come from practice volume, not from insight.

The official topic list

Number system, decimals, fractions, LCM, HCF, ratio and proportion, percentage, mensuration, time and work, time and distance, simple and compound interest, profit and loss, elementary algebra, geometry and trigonometry, elementary statistics. That is the complete list, printed in the notification. There is no calculus, no coordinate geometry, no probability beyond elementary statistics.

How to spend eight weeks on it

Divide the thirteen topics into three tiers by how often they appear and how cheap they are to master. Do not study them in the order the notification lists them.

Tier	Topics	Why
Tier 1, do these first	Percentage, ratio and proportion, profit and loss, simple and compound interest, average	These five feed each other. Percentage is the parent of profit and loss and of interest, and ratio is the parent of partnership and mixture problems.
Tier 2, do these next	Time and work, time and distance, number system, HCF and LCM, decimals and fractions	Formula-driven and highly repetitive. Twenty questions per topic is usually enough.
Tier 3, do these last	Mensuration, elementary algebra, geometry and trigonometry, elementary statistics	Higher formula load, lower frequency. Learn the formula sheet and the eight standard question types, and stop.

The formula sheet

Learn these thirty. Every one of them appears in at least one question in a typical paper.

Area of use	Formula
Percentage change	(change / original) x 100
Successive change of a% and b%	a + b + ab/100
Profit percent	(SP - CP) / CP x 100
Discount percent	(MP - SP) / MP x 100
Simple interest	P x R x T / 100
Compound interest	P (1 + R/100)^T - P
Difference CI minus SI, 2 years	P (R/100)^2
Work: combined rate	1/A + 1/B = 1/T
Speed, distance, time	D = S x T; 1 km/h = 5/18 m/s
Train crossing a pole	Time = length of train / speed
Train crossing a platform	Time = (train + platform) / speed
Upstream and downstream	Down = u + v; Up = u - v

Area of use	Formula
Average	Sum of terms / number of terms
Average of first n natural numbers	n(n+1) / 2n = (n+1)/2
Ratio split of amount A in x:y:z	A x/(x+y+z), A y/(x+y+z), A z/(x+y+z)
Area of circle	pi r^2
Circumference of circle	2 pi r
Area of triangle	1/2 x base x height
Area of equilateral triangle	(sqrt3/4) a^2
Volume of cylinder	pi r^2 h
Curved surface of cylinder	2 pi r h
Volume of sphere	4/3 pi r^3
Volume of cone	1/3 pi r^2 h
Area of rectangle, perimeter	l x b; 2(l + b)
Area of trapezium	1/2 (a + b) h
Pythagoras	h^2 = p^2 + b^2
Sum of first n natural numbers	n(n+1)/2
Sum of squares of first n	n(n+1)(2n+1)/6
Mean of grouped data	Sum of fx / Sum of f

Three worked examples

1. A shopkeeper marks his goods 40% above cost and then allows a 25% discount. Find his profit percent. Marked price is 1.40 times cost. Selling price is 0.75 x 1.40 = 1.05 times cost. Profit is 5%. Using the successive-change formula with a = +40 and b = -25: 40 - 25 - (40 x 25)/100 = 15 - 10 = 5.

2. A can finish a job in 12 days and B in 18 days. Working together, how long? Combined rate is 1/12 + 1/18 = 3/36 + 2/36 = 5/36. Time is 36/5 = 7.2 days, or 7 days and 4.8 hours.

3. A sum becomes Rs. 10,000 in two years at 10% compound interest. Find the principal. P x 1.21 = 10,000, so P = 10,000 / 1.21 = Rs. 8,264.46. If the question gives simple interest instead, P = 10,000 / 1.20 = Rs. 8,333.33. The two answers differing by Rs. 69 is exactly the kind of distractor the paper uses.

> **The only rule that matters in this section**
> Twenty questions per topic, timed. Not solved while looking at the solution, not solved while watching a video. Twenty questions with a clock running, then check, then redo the wrong ones the next day. That is the entire method and it works because the topics are finite.

CHAPTER 13

Reasoning: six patterns repeat, and speed is the skill

The syllabus looks long. In practice six question patterns account for most of the paper, and each one has a settled method you can learn in an afternoon.

The official topic list

Analogies; completion of number and alphabetical series; coding and decoding; mathematical operations; similarities and differences; relationships; analytical reasoning; syllogism; jumbling; Venn diagrams; puzzle; data sufficiency; statement and conclusion; statement and courses of action; decision making; maps; interpretation of graphs.

The six that repeat

Pattern	The method	Typical share
Number and letter series	Check differences, then ratios, then alternating patterns. For letters, convert to positions 1 to 26.	4 to 6 questions
Coding and decoding	Write the alphabet with positions above it. Test a fixed shift first, then reverse order, then position arithmetic.	3 to 4 questions
Syllogism	Draw two circles per statement. A conclusion is valid only if it holds in every possible arrangement.	3 to 4 questions
Blood relations and direction	Draw a tree for relations and a compass grid for directions. Never hold it in your head.	3 to 4 questions
Seating and puzzles	Fix the most constrained clue first, then place the rest. If two arrangements survive, the puzzle is designed to need both.	4 to 6 questions
Ranking and ordering	Position from the other end is total minus position plus one.	2 to 3 questions

Three worked examples

1. 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ? The differences are 4, 6, 8, 10, so the next difference is 12 and the answer is 42. Equivalently, the terms are n(n+1) for n = 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, so the sixth is 6 x 7 = 42.

2. If PEN is coded as QFO, how is INK coded? Each letter moves forward one place: P to Q, E to F, N to O. So I to J, N to O, K to L. The answer is JOL.

3. All pens are books. No book is a table. Which conclusion follows? 'No pen is a table.' Every pen is inside the books circle, and the books circle does not touch the tables circle, so no pen can be a table. The conclusion follows.

The clock rule you will use at least twice

Angle between the hands at H hours and M minutes is |30H - 5.5M| degrees, taken as the smaller angle. At 3:30 that is |90 - 165| = 75 degrees. Learn the formula rather than the table; the table runs out and the formula does not.

Practise with a pencil, not in your head

Every reasoning topic in this paper has a diagram method: circles for syllogism, trees for relations, grids for direction, tables for seating. Candidates who lose marks here are almost always the ones trying to hold the arrangement in working memory while the clock runs. Paper is provided at the centre. Use it from the first practice set.

CHAPTER 14

The ninety minutes, hour by hour, minute by minute

What you do in the exam hall is a rehearsed procedure, not a test of character. Rehearse it in every mock so that the real thing is the tenth time you have done it.

Before the paper

- Download the exam city intimation about ten days before the test, and the e-call letter about four days before. Both come from your board's page on the unified RRB website.
- Carry a colour print of the e-call letter and your Aadhaar card. The notification requires Aadhaar as identity proof at the CBT, the rally or verification, and the medical examination.
- Gates open ninety minutes before the scheduled start and close thirty minutes before it. A candidate who arrives after the gate closes is not accommodated on another date.
- Carry nothing else. No pen, no pencil, no paper, no watch, no water bottle, no bag, no belt, no cap, no mobile phone in any state. A pen is provided at the centre.
- Do not apply henna or mehndi on your hands or feet. It obstructs the biometric capture and the notification says so explicitly.
- Expect frisking, admit card and Aadhaar verification including facial or biometric authentication, auto-allotted hall, attendance, iris and thumb capture inside the hall, and exit biometric.

The first five minutes

Do not start answering. Read the instruction page, confirm the paper has 100 questions, and note where the review-mark button and the question palette are. Then go to General Awareness, not to question one. If question one is a mathematics problem, you have already spent your best minutes on your slowest section.

The clock, in four checkpoints

Checkpoint	You should be at	If you are behind
20 minutes gone	General Awareness finished	Abandon the remaining GA questions and move on. They will not improve.
55 minutes gone	Half of Reasoning done	Switch to the reasoning questions with short stems; leave puzzles for pass two.
80 minutes gone	Mathematics pass one done	Stop solving. Go straight to pass three.
90 minutes	Every 50-50 answered	Answer everything remaining, even blind. A blank is a certain zero.

Three rules for the hall

1. **Two minutes on any question, maximum, in pass one.** If it has not opened up, mark it and leave. The question you abandon is worth one mark; the three you reach instead are worth three.
2. **Answer every question you have narrowed to two options.** Chapter 8 showed the arithmetic: a 50-50 is worth a third of a mark every time. Blank 50-50s are the most common self-inflicted loss in this exam.

3 **Never change an answer without a reason.** Changing on a hunch converts correct answers into wrong ones at roughly the rate of chance, which with negative marking is a net loss.

After the paper

The board publishes the response sheet and the question paper with the correct option marked, accessible by logging in with your registration number and date of birth. Use it. It tells you which section cost you the shortlist, which is the only diagnostic worth having before CBT-2. Do not spend the waiting period arguing about individual questions on social media; the answer key is the only opinion that counts.

CHAPTER 15

The mock system: three hours of repair for every hour of testing

Most candidates take a mock, read the score, feel something, and take another mock. That is not practice. That is measurement without repair.

A mock test is a diagnostic instrument. It tells you which questions you could not do and, more usefully, which ones you could have done and did not. The value is entirely in what happens in the three hours after the test, not in the ninety minutes during it.

The 1:3 rule

For every ninety-minute mock, spend three hours repairing it. The repair has four parts, and the fourth is the one everybody skips.

1. **Re-solve every wrong answer from scratch, without the solution.** Twenty minutes. If you get it right this time, the question was a knowledge gap. If you get it wrong again, it is a method gap and it needs a different fix.
2. **Read the solution only for the questions you failed twice.** Forty minutes. Note the specific step you missed, not the topic. 'I forgot to convert km/h to m/s' is actionable; 'time and distance is weak' is not.
3. **Re-attempt every question you left blank but could have narrowed to two options.** Forty minutes. This is where the marks are. Count how many you abandoned and multiply by 0.33 to see what the habit is costing you.
4. **Log the reason, not the topic.** Twenty minutes. Every entry goes in one of five boxes: did not know the fact, knew it but doubted, knew the method but misapplied it, ran out of time, misread the question.

The error log, which is the only study artefact you will keep

Question	Section	Reason code	The one thing to fix	Re-test date
Q34	Maths	Method misapplied	Convert km/h to m/s before dividing	8 Nov
Q61	Reasoning	Ran out of time	Stop solving puzzles in pass one	8 Nov
Q12	GA	Knew it but doubted	Article 32 vs 226, make one line	9 Nov
Q78	Maths	Misread question	Circle the word 'compound' every time	9 Nov
Q88	Reasoning	Did not know the fact	Learn the clock-angle formula	9 Nov

After four mocks, sort the log by reason code. If most entries are 'did not know the fact', you have a coverage problem and you should read more. If most are 'ran out of time', you have a pacing problem and reading more will not help. If most are 'knew it but doubted', you have a confidence problem and the fix is retrieval practice, not revision.

Where to get mocks

Start with the official practice tests. The notification states that mock and practice tests will be made available on the unified RRB website so candidates can familiarise themselves with the online examination process. Sit at least two of those first, purely for the interface: the question palette, the review-mark button, the section navigation. Candidates lose real marks to an unfamiliar screen, and that is the one variable you can eliminate for free.

Then move to full-length timed tests on the notification's own pattern: 100 questions, 90 minutes, 30 mathematics, 30 reasoning, 40 general awareness, one third negative marking. If a test series uses a different pattern, it is measuring a different exam. Check the pattern before you trust the percentile.

How many mocks, honestly

Twelve to fifteen full-length mocks between now and CBT-1 is the right order of magnitude. Fewer than eight and you have not built the pacing. More than twenty and you are testing rather than learning, and the repair log stops being read. The number matters far less than whether every mock gets its three hours.

> **The score you should track**
>
> Not your total. Track two numbers: the number of 50-50 questions you answered, and your accuracy on the questions you were certain about. The first should rise steadily. The second should stay above 90%. If your total is rising but your certainty accuracy is falling, you are guessing more and learning less, and the next mock will correct you painfully.

CHAPTER 16

Document verification and the medical: the last three weeks

This is the stage where candidates who cleared both papers lose the post. Almost every failure here is a date on a certificate, not a fact about the candidate.

The board verifies eligibility against original documents only after you have qualified in all stages and been provisionally shortlisted for document verification. The notification is blunt about the consequence of any mismatch: if a claim made in the application is not substantiated by certificates, the candidature is cancelled, and no additional time is given to produce originals.

The document set

Document	What it must prove	The trap
Class 10 certificate or mark sheet	Your date of birth	Must match the application to the day. No change is permitted afterwards.
Degree certificate (CEN 06) or Class 12 certificate (CEN 07)	That you hold the qualification	Must carry a date of issue
Consolidated marksheet or semester mark sheets	The date your final result was declared	Needed when the certificate itself is dated after the closing date
Caste or community certificate	SC, ST or OBC-NCL status	Must be valid as on the closing date, in the prescribed format
EWS certificate	Economically Weaker Section status	Must be valid as on the closing date
PwBD certificate	Benchmark disability	Must be held on or before the closing date
Ex-Servicemen employment certificate	Probable date of discharge	Valid as on the closing date; self-declaration also required
EBC certificate, BPL card or Izzat MST	Fee-concession claim	Original must be produced or the candidature is liable to be rejected
Minority affidavit on stamp paper	Fee-waiver claim	Must be produced at DV, not later
Aadhaar card	Identity at every stage	The one on the e-call letter

The three failures that actually happen

The certificate is dated after the closing date. This is the most common. The relief exists: a consolidated marksheet showing when the result was declared, or individual semester mark sheets with declaration dates, establishes that you held the qualification in time. If none of your documents carries a date, get a certificate from your institute or board now, not in March.

The name does not match. If you changed your name, the notification requires you to indicate the changed name as well as the name on your Class 10 certificate at the appropriate places in the application, and all other details must match the certificate. If the change happened after you applied, you have a problem that only the board can answer.

The caste certificate is not in the prescribed format. A state-format OBC certificate, or one that has expired, is not the same as the central format the notification requires. Check the annexure, not a coaching centre's sample.

The medical examination

The medical is conducted by a railway medical authority after document verification. It tests the standard attached to the post you opted for, which is why Chapter 4 told you to order your preferences around it. The notification notes that a candidate who fails to acquire the required standard at the initial examination may be offered one last and final opportunity to prefer a medical appeal on payment of prescribed charges. If you avail it within the allowed time, the appeal result is final and binding. If you do not, the initial result stands.

There is also an antecedent and character verification before appointment. Declare anything that needs declaring. Suppression is treated far more seriously than the underlying fact in almost every case, and the notification provides for lifetime debarment from RRB and RRC examinations where information is found to have been suppressed.

> **Do this in November, not in March**
> Photocopy every document on the list, keep the originals in one envelope, and check each date against the closing date of the notification you applied under. Six of the ten documents have a date condition tied to that closing date. Finding out in March that one of them fails is the worst possible outcome of a two-year effort.

CHAPTER 17

After the offer: what the job actually is

Selection by the board does not confer a right of appointment. Understanding what comes next is part of choosing whether to apply.

The offer is issued by the zone, not the board

The notification states plainly that selection by the Railway Recruitment Board does not confer any right of appointment. The board's function is to recommend names of suitable candidates to the zonal railway, which issues the offer of appointment subject to availability of vacancies and satisfaction of all eligibility criteria, including antecedents of character. Allotment of post, railway and zone is by merit, preference, medical fitness and vacancy position on the date the panel is prepared.

Training, and the stipend

Selected candidates undergo training wherever prescribed, and only a stipend is paid during the training period. Plan your first six months on a stipend, not on the full pay of the level you were selected for. This surprises people who budgeted from the initial basic pay figure.

Pay, in the terms the notification uses

Post	Level	Initial basic pay	What sits on top
Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor	6	Rs. 35,400	Dearness allowance, house rent allowance, transport allowance as applicable
Goods Train Manager	5	Rs. 29,200	As above, plus running-staff allowances as admissible to the post
Junior Accounts Assistant cum Typist	5	Rs. 29,200	As above
Senior Clerk cum Typist	5	Rs. 29,200	As above
Commercial cum Ticket Clerk	3	Rs. 21,700	As above
Junior Clerk, Accounts Clerk, Trains Clerk	2	Rs. 19,900	As above

The notification gives the initial basic pay under the 7th Central Pay Commission and states that applicable allowances and service conditions are governed by the relevant rules. It does not publish a take-home figure, and any take-home figure you see elsewhere is an estimate. Ask your zone for the current allowance position before you plan a household budget.

Posting and transfer, which is the part people underestimate

A railway servant is ordinarily employed throughout service on the railway where they were first posted, and has no claim as a right to transfer to another railway. No request for transfer to another railway is registered until the newly appointed candidate completes at least five to ten years of service. A competent authority can transfer you to any department or railway establishment, including a project in or out of India, in the exigencies of service.

Read that again before you choose your RRB in Chapter 3. The board you pick is, in practice, the region you will live in for the first decade of your career. Candidates who choose a board for its cut-off history and then discover they cannot get home twice a year have made an expensive trade.

Three obligations that appear in small print

- Selected candidates who are finally appointed are liable for active service in the Railway Engineers' Unit of the Territorial Army.
- Selected candidates execute a security or indemnity bond wherever necessary at the time of joining the railway or the post.
- Pension and retirement coverage follows the central government rules in force at the time of your appointment. Read your offer letter rather than a forum post; the rules have changed more than once in the last two decades.

Promotion, in honest terms

Promotion within the railway is driven by departmental examinations, seniority in the grade and vacancy in the higher grade. The notification does not publish a promotion timeline and neither will I. What is fair to say is that a Level 2 entrant and a Level 6 entrant are on the same ladder, at different rungs, and the ladder is long. Candidates who join at Level 6 begin closer to the supervisory grades; candidates who join at Level 2 have further to climb and more years of departmental examinations ahead of them.

> **The question to ask yourself before you apply**
> Would you take this post if the pay never rose and the posting never changed? If yes, apply, and treat every promotion afterwards as a bonus. If the answer is no, the post is not the problem, and no preference-list ordering will fix it.

CHAPTER 18

The twelve-week plan, dated from 2 November 2026

The CBT dates have not been announced. That is an advantage, not a problem: a plan that is ready early survives an announcement that comes late.

This calendar assumes you want to be examination-ready by the end of January 2027, which is earlier than any plausible CBT-1 date. Use the first two weeks to finish the application and start the static General Awareness block in parallel, because those two things do not compete for the same hours.

Week	Dates	Mathematics	Reasoning	General Awareness	Deliverable
1	2 to 8 Nov	Percentage, ratio and proportion	Number and letter series	NCERT Science, chapters 1 to 4	Application submitted, fee paid
2	9 to 15 Nov	Profit and loss, simple interest	Coding and decoding	NCERT Science, chapters 5 to 9	Bank account seeded and verified
3	16 to 22 Nov	Compound interest, average	Syllogism	NCERT Science, chapters 10 to 14	Mock 1 and full repair log
4	23 to 29 Nov	Time and work	Blood relations, direction sense	NCERT History, ancient and medieval	Mock 2
5	30 Nov to 6 Dec	Time and distance	Seating and puzzles	NCERT History, modern India	Mock 3, freedom struggle timeline made
6	7 to 13 Dec	Number system, HCF and LCM	Ranking and ordering	NCERT Geography, physical	Mock 4
7	14 to 20 Dec	Decimals and fractions, elementary algebra	Analytical reasoning	NCERT Geography, India	Mock 5, first full revision of formulas
8	21 to 27 Dec	Mensuration	Statement and conclusion	NCERT Civics and polity	Mock 6
9	28 Dec to 3 Jan	Geometry and trigonometry	Data sufficiency, Venn diagrams	Indian economy, one page	Mock 7, error log sorted by reason code
10	4 to 10 Jan	Elementary statistics	Mixed sets, timed	Current affairs, months 1 to 4	Mock 8 and 9
11	11 to 17 Jan	All topics, timed sets only	All topics, timed sets only	Current affairs, months 5 to 8	Mock 10 and 11, formula sheet recited from memory
12	18 to 24 Jan	Weak topics from the log only	Weak topics from the log only	Current affairs, months 9 to 12	Mock 12, official practice tests sat twice

How to use this calendar without failing it

- Three hours a day on weekdays and five on one weekend day is enough. Twelve hours a day for two weeks and then nothing for a month is the most common failure pattern.
- Do the static General Awareness block every day, twenty minutes, before anything else. It is the only block that compounds.
- If a week slips, drop the mathematics topic, not the mock. The mock is the diagnostic; the topic can be recovered later.

- From week 9, stop learning new mathematics. Consolidate. New topics this late produce anxiety and no marks.
- When the CBT date is announced, count back three weeks and make the last three weeks mock-only. Nothing new enters after that point.

CHAPTER 19

Sixty practice questions, with answers and reasons

Twenty-two mathematics, eighteen reasoning, twenty static general awareness. Time yourself: the mathematics and reasoning blocks should take fifty-five minutes together, the general awareness block twenty-two.

The general awareness questions here are deliberately static, not current affairs. Current affairs cannot be responsibly printed in a book that may be read weeks after it was written, and the notification's own syllabus asks for both. Build the current affairs half from your monthly digest in Chapter 11.

Mathematics and reasoning, questions 1 to 40

Q1. Find the HCF of 24, 36 and 60. (a) 6 (b) 12 (c) 18 (d) 24

Q2. Find the LCM of 12, 15 and 20. (a) 30 (b) 45 (c) 60 (d) 120

Q3. A shopkeeper marks his goods 40% above cost and allows a 25% discount. His profit percent is: (a) 5% (b) 10% (c) 15% (d) 20%

Q4. Simple interest on Rs. 12,000 at 8% per annum for 3 years is: (a) Rs. 2,400 (b) Rs. 2,880 (c) Rs. 3,120 (d) Rs. 3,600

Q5. Compound interest on Rs. 10,000 at 10% per annum for 2 years is: (a) Rs. 2,000 (b) Rs. 2,100 (c) Rs. 2,200 (d) Rs. 2,310

Q6. A train 180 m long runs at 54 km/h. Time taken to cross a pole: (a) 10 s (b) 12 s (c) 15 s (d) 18 s

Q7. Rs. 4,200 is divided in the ratio 3 : 4 : 5. The largest share is: (a) Rs. 1,050 (b) Rs. 1,400 (c) Rs. 1,750 (d) Rs. 2,100

Q8. A can do a job in 12 days and B in 18 days. Working together they finish it in: (a) 6 days (b) 7.2 days (c) 8 days (d) 9 days

Q9. 15% of 480 is: (a) 62 (b) 68 (c) 72 (d) 76

Q10. The average of the first 20 natural numbers is: (a) 10 (b) 10.5 (c) 11 (d) 20

Q11. The area of a circle of radius 7 cm is: (a) 44 sq cm (b) 154 sq cm (c) 308 sq cm (d) 616 sq cm

Q12. The volume of a cylinder of radius 7 cm and height 10 cm is: (a) 440 cu cm (b) 1,540 cu cm (c) 2,200 cu cm (d) 3,080 cu cm

Q13. An article bought for Rs. 400 is sold for Rs. 460. The profit percent is: (a) 12% (b) 15% (c) 18% (d) 20%

Q14. An article marked at Rs. 850 is sold for Rs. 680. The discount percent is: (a) 15% (b) 18% (c) 20% (d) 25%

Q15. The value of 0.6 x 0.6 + 0.4 x 0.4 is: (a) 0.42 (b) 0.48 (c) 0.52 (d) 0.60

Q16. A boat's speed in still water is 10 km/h and the stream flows at 2 km/h. Time to cover 24 km downstream: (a) 1.5 h (b) 2 h (c) 2.4 h (d) 3 h

Q17. A father is three times as old as his son and their ages add to 48. The son's age is: (a) 10 years (b) 12 years (c) 14 years (d) 16 years

Q18. Two successive discounts of 10% and 20% are equivalent to a single discount of: (a) 26% (b) 28% (c) 30% (d) 32%

Q19. Five men finish a job in 8 days. Eight men will finish it in: (a) 4 days (b) 5 days (c) 5.5 days (d) 6 days

Q20. The square root of 1,764 is: (a) 38 (b) 40 (c) 42 (d) 44

Q21. The ratio of the areas of two circles with radii r and 2r is: (a) 1 : 2 (b) 1 : 4 (c) 1 : 8 (d) 2 : 1

Q22. A number is increased by 25% and then decreased by 20%. The net change is: (a) 5% increase (b) 5% decrease (c) no change (d) 20% increase

Q23. 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ? (a) 36 (b) 40 (c) 42 (d) 48

Q24. 3, 7, 15, 31, ? (a) 47 (b) 55 (c) 63 (d) 67

Q25. If PEN is coded as QFO, then INK is coded as: (a) JOL (b) JML (c) HML (d) JNL

Q26. All roses are flowers. Some flowers fade quickly. Which conclusion follows? (a) Some roses fade quickly (b) All flowers are roses (c) No rose fades quickly (d) None of these conclusions follows

Q27. A is B's sister and C is B's mother. A is C's: (a) sister (b) mother (c) daughter (d) aunt

Q28. A man walks 8 km north, then 6 km east. His distance from the starting point is: (a) 10 km (b) 12 km (c) 14 km (d) 16 km

Q29. Find the odd one out: 3, 5, 7, 9, 11 (a) 3 (b) 5 (c) 9 (d) 11

Q30. Doctor is to Hospital as Teacher is to: (a) Student (b) Book (c) School (d) Lesson

Q31. In a row of 40 students, Ram is 12th from the left. His position from the right is: (a) 28th (b) 29th (c) 30th (d) 31st

Q32. The angle between the hands of a clock at 3:30 is: (a) 65 degrees (b) 70 degrees (c) 75 degrees (d) 90 degrees

Q33. 5, 11, 23, 47, ? (a) 83 (b) 91 (c) 95 (d) 99

Q34. If A = 1, B = 2 and so on, the sum of the letters in CAB is: (a) 4 (b) 5 (c) 6 (d) 7

Q35. All pens are books. No book is a table. Which conclusion follows? (a) Some pens are tables (b) No pen is a table (c) All books are pens (d) Some tables are pens

Q36. AZ, BY, CX, ? (a) DV (b) DW (c) EW (d) DX

Q37. Facing north, a man turns 90 degrees clockwise twice. He is now facing: (a) North (b) East (c) South (d) West

Q38. P's father is Q's son. Q is P's: (a) father (b) brother (c) grandfather (d) uncle

Q39. 1, 4, 9, 16, ? (a) 20 (b) 24 (c) 25 (d) 36

Q40. Some doctors are teachers. All teachers are graduates. Which conclusion follows? (a) All doctors are graduates (b) Some doctors are graduates (c) No doctor is a graduate (d) All graduates are doctors

Static general awareness, questions 41 to 60

Q41. The first railway line in India, opened in 1853, ran between: (a) Delhi and Agra (b) Bombay and Thane (c) Calcutta and Delhi (d) Madras and Arcot

Q42. The headquarters of South Central Railway is at: (a) Secunderabad (b) Bhubaneswar (c) Bilaspur (d) Nagpur

Q43. Chittaranjan Locomotive Works is an Indian Railways production unit that manufactures: (a) Diesel locomotives (b) Electric locomotives (c) Coaches (d) Wagons

Q44. The Fundamental Duties were added to the Constitution by which amendment? (a) 24th (b) 42nd (c) 44th (d) 52nd

Q45. The Directive Principles of State Policy were borrowed from the Constitution of: (a) USA (b) Ireland (c) Canada (d) Australia

Q46. The right to constitutional remedies is guaranteed by which article? (a) Article 19 (b) Article 21 (c) Article 32 (d) Article 44

Q47. The Tropic of Cancer passes through how many Indian states? (a) 6 (b) 7 (c) 8 (d) 9

Q48. The highest mountain peak lying entirely within India is: (a) Nanda Devi (b) Kangchenjunga (c) Kamet (d) Saltoro Kangri

Q49. Which river is known as the Sorrow of Bihar? (a) Gandak (b) Kosi (c) Son (d) Ghaghara

Q50. Indian Standard Time is based on the longitude: (a) 80 degrees 30 minutes E (b) 82 degrees 30 minutes E (c) 85 degrees 30 minutes E (d) 88 degrees 30 minutes E

Q51. The Battle of Plassey was fought in: (a) 1757 (b) 1764 (c) 1761 (d) 1857

Q52. The Indian National Congress was founded in 1885 by: (a) Dadabhai Naoroji (b) A. O. Hume (c) W. C. Bonnerjee (d) Surendranath Banerjee

Q53. The Quit India Movement was launched in: (a) 1930 (b) 1935 (c) 1942 (d) 1946

Q54. The SI unit of electric current is: (a) volt (b) ohm (c) ampere (d) watt

Q55. The most abundant gas in the Earth's atmosphere is: (a) oxygen (b) nitrogen (c) carbon dioxide (d) argon

Q56. Deficiency of Vitamin C causes: (a) rickets (b) scurvy (c) beriberi (d) night blindness

Q57. The organelle known as the powerhouse of the cell is the: (a) nucleus (b) ribosome (c) mitochondrion (d) Golgi body

Q58. The blood group known as the universal donor is: (a) A positive (b) AB positive (c) O negative (d) B negative

Q59. The largest gland in the human body is the: (a) pancreas (b) thyroid (c) liver (d) spleen

Answer key and reasons

Score one mark for each correct answer and deduct one third for each wrong one, exactly as the examination does. If you scored below 40 in the general awareness block, the problem is coverage, not intelligence.

Q	Ans	Why
1	B	HCF of 24, 36, 60 is 12. Factorise: 2^3x3, 2^2x3^2, 2^2x3x5. Common factors are 2^2 and 3.
2	C	12 = 2^2x3, 15 = 3x5, 20 = 2^2x5. LCM takes the highest power of each prime: 2^2 x 3 x 5 = 60.
3	A	1.40 x 0.75 = 1.05, so profit is 5%. By the successive-change formula: 40 - 25 - (40x25)/100 = 5.
4	B	SI = P x R x T / 100 = 12,000 x 8 x 3 / 100 = Rs. 2,880.
5	B	10,000 x 1.21 = 12,100. Interest = Rs. 2,100. The extra Rs. 100 over simple interest is interest on the first year's interest.
6	B	54 km/h = 54 x 5/18 = 15 m/s. Time = 180 / 15 = 12 s.
7	C	Total parts = 12. Largest share = 4,200 x 5/12 = Rs. 1,750.
8	B	Combined rate = 1/12 + 1/18 = 5/36. Time = 36/5 = 7.2 days.
9	C	480 x 15/100 = 72.
10	B	Sum = 20 x 21 / 2 = 210. Average = 210 / 20 = 10.5. Equivalently (n+1)/2 = 10.5.
11	B	Area = pi r^2 = 22/7 x 49 = 154 sq cm.
12	B	Volume = pi r^2 h = 22/7 x 49 x 10 = 1,540 cu cm.
13	B	Profit = 60. Profit percent = 60/400 x 100 = 15%.
14	C	Discount = 170. Percent = 170/850 x 100 = 20%.
15	C	0.36 + 0.16 = 0.52.
16	B	Downstream speed = 12 km/h. Time = 24 / 12 = 2 h.
17	B	Let the son be x. Then 3x + x = 48, so x = 12.
18	B	0.90 x 0.80 = 0.72, so the customer pays 72% and the discount is 28%.
19	B	Work = 5 x 8 = 40 man-days. 40 / 8 = 5 days.
20	C	42 x 42 = 1,764.
21	B	Area scales with the square of the radius, so the ratio is r^2 : 4r^2 = 1 : 4.
22	C	1.25 x 0.80 = 1.00. The two changes exactly cancel.
23	C	Differences are 4, 6, 8, 10, so the next is 12. 30 + 12 = 42. The terms are n(n+1).
24	C	Each term is double the previous plus one: 31 x 2 + 1 = 63.
25	A	Every letter moves forward one place. I to J, N to O, K to L.
26	D	The roses are inside the flowers circle, but the fading flowers may all lie outside the roses part. The conclusion is possible but not certain, so it does not follow.
27	C	If C is B's mother and A is B's sister, A is also C's daughter.
28	A	The two legs are perpendicular, so the distance is sqrt(64 + 36) = sqrt(100) = 10 km.
29	C	Every number except 9 is prime. 9 = 3 x 3.
30	C	The relation is person to workplace.

Q	Ans	Why
31	B	Position from the other end is total minus position plus one: 40 - 12 + 1 = 29.
32	C	Angle = |30H - 5.5M| = |90 - 165| = 75 degrees.
33	C	Each term is double the previous plus one: 47 x 2 + 1 = 95.
34	C	C = 3, A = 1, B = 2. Sum = 6.
35	B	Every pen sits inside the books circle, and the books circle is entirely outside the tables circle. So no pen can be a table.
36	B	The first letter moves forward through the alphabet, the second moves backward: A,B,C,D and Z,Y,X,W.
37	C	Each clockwise quarter turn moves north to east, then east to south.
38	C	Q's son is P's father, so Q is P's grandfather.
39	C	These are perfect squares: 1, 4, 9, 16, 25.
40	B	The doctors who are teachers fall inside the graduates circle, so at least some doctors are graduates.
41	B	The first passenger line ran from Bori Bunder in Bombay to Thane, about 34 km, on 16 April 1853.
42	A	South Central Railway is headquartered at Secunderabad.
43	B	CLW at Chittaranjan produces electric locomotives. Diesel locomotives come from the Banaras Locomotive Works; coaches from the Integral Coach Factory; wagons from several wagon workshops.
44	B	The 42nd Amendment Act, 1976, inserted Part IVA and Article 51A on Fundamental Duties.
45	B	The Directive Principles follow the Irish Constitution; Fundamental Rights follow the American Bill of Rights.
46	C	Article 32 allows a person to move the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights. Dr. Ambedkar called it the heart and soul of the Constitution.
47	C	It passes through Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura and Mizoram, which is eight states.
48	B	Kangchenjunga, on the Sikkim border, is the highest peak within India. Mount Everest and K2 are higher but lie outside Indian territory.
49	B	The Kosi shifts course and floods across north Bihar, which earned it the name.
50	B	IST is the local time of 82 degrees 30 minutes east, which passes near Mirzapur in Uttar Pradesh.
51	A	Robert Clive defeated Siraj-ud-Daulah at Plassey in 1757. Buxar followed in 1764.
52	B	A. O. Hume, a retired British civil servant, founded the Congress in 1885. W. C. Bonnerjee was its first president.
53	C	Gandhi gave the Quit India call on 8 August 1942 at the Bombay session of the All India Congress Committee.
54	C	The ampere is the SI base unit of electric current. Volt is potential difference, ohm is resistance, watt is power.
55	B	Nitrogen is about 78% of dry air by volume, oxygen about 21%.
56	B	Scurvy is caused by Vitamin C deficiency. Rickets is Vitamin D, beriberi is Vitamin B1, night blindness is Vitamin A.
57	C	Mitochondria generate most of the cell's ATP through respiration.
58	C	O negative red cells carry neither A nor B antigens nor the RhD antigen, so they can be given to any recipient in an emergency.
59	C	The liver is the largest gland and the largest internal organ in the human body.

CHAPTER A

The one-page action card

Photograph this page. It is the only part of the book you need in the week you apply.

If you are applying under	CEN 06/2026 Graduate	CEN 07/2026 Undergraduate
Applications close	6 Nov 2026, 23:59	13 Nov 2026, 23:59
Fee closes	8 Nov 2026	15 Nov 2026
Corrections	9 to 18 Nov, Rs. 250 each	16 to 25 Nov, Rs. 250 each
Qualification	Any degree, held by closing date	Class 12, 50% aggregate
Age on 1 Jan 2027	18 to 33	18 to 30
Fee	Rs. 500, Rs. 400 refunded	Rs. 500, Rs. 400 refunded
Concession fee	Rs. 250, fully refunded	Rs. 250, fully refunded
Portal	rrbapply.gov.in	rrbapply.gov.in
Official site	rrb.indianrailways.gov.in	rrb.indianrailways.gov.in

Paper	GA	Maths	Reasoning	Total	Time
CBT-1	40	30	30	100	90 min
CBT-2	50	35	35	120	90 min

Category	Qualifying marks
UR and EWS	40%
OBC-NCL and SC	30%
ST	25%

Five things that are irreversible

Your chosen RRB. Your mobile number and email on the account. Your date of birth as entered. Whether you applied to more than one RRB. Whether your Aadhaar-seeded bank account works. Everything else can be corrected for Rs. 250 inside the window.

CHAPTER B

Official links and how to verify anything in this book

This book is a reading of two documents. If anything in it matters to a decision you are about to make, go to the source. It takes four minutes.

What you need	Where it is
The unified RRB website, all notices and results	rrb.indianrailways.gov.in
The application portal	rrbapply.gov.in
CEN 06/2026 and CEN 07/2026, full text with annexures	The unified RRB website, Recruitment CENs section
Your board's own page, cut-offs and results	Each RRB's page linked from the unified site
Indian Railway Medical Manual, Volume I, Chapter 5	indianrailways.gov.in, under Railway Board codes and manuals
Indian Railways zones and production units	indianrailways.gov.in
Press release on the graduate notification, 11 October 2026	pib.gov.in
Application helpline, 10:00 to 17:00 on working days	rrb.help@csc.gov.in, 9592001188 or 01725653333

Sources used for this edition

- Centralised Employment Notification No. 06/2026, Non-Technical Popular Categories (Graduate), Railway Recruitment Boards, Ministry of Railways. Vacancies, pay levels, medical standards, age bands, fees, refund mechanics, exam pattern, qualifying marks, shortlisting ratios and document requirements are taken from this notification.
- Centralised Employment Notification No. 07/2026, Non-Technical Popular Categories (Undergraduate), Railway Recruitment Boards. Posts, vacancies, category split, 50% aggregate rule and its exemptions, date-of-birth windows and fee structure.
- Press Information Bureau release dated 11 October 2026 on the 3,548 graduate-level vacancies, used to cross-check post counts, pay levels and the application timeline.
- CBT-1 cut-off notices published by individual Railway Recruitment Boards on 19 September 2025 for CEN 05/2024 (NTPC Graduate), and on 11 June 2026 for CEN 06/2025 at RRB Bhopal. These are the source of every cut-off figure quoted in Chapter 3.
- Indian Railway Medical Manual, Volume I, Chapter 5, and Railway Board letter 2022/H/5/1/NER/Dalbir dated 25 August 2022, both referenced from the notification, for the medical standards and the refractive-surgery position.

What this book cannot do

It cannot tell you the CBT dates, because they have not been announced. It cannot tell you the cut-off for your board this cycle, because cut-offs are produced by the marks of the people who apply. It cannot guarantee that a vacancy count will hold, because the notification itself says vacancies are provisional and may increase, decrease or become nil. What it can do is make sure none of those uncertainties cost you a candidature you were entitled to.

CHAPTER C

Glossary

Term	What it means here
A-2, B-2, C-2, A-3	Railway medical standards. A-2 is the strictest and excludes refractive surgery.
CBT	Computer Based Test. CBT-1 is the screening paper; CBT-2 is the selection paper.
CCTS	Chief Commercial cum Ticket Supervisor, the Level 6 post in CEN 06/2026.
CEN	Centralised Employment Notification, the document that announces a recruitment.
DV	Document Verification, where originals are checked against your application.
EBC	Economically Backward Class. Fee concession only, no reservation.
EWS	Economically Weaker Section. A reserved category with its own cut-off.
ExSM	Ex-Servicemen.
GTM	Goods Train Manager, the Level 5 A-2 post holding 2,750 of the 3,548 graduate vacancies.
Normalisation	Rescaling of marks across shifts so that difficulty differences do not decide selection.
NTPC	Non-Technical Popular Categories, the group of posts this recruitment covers.
OBC-NCL	Other Backward Class, Non-Creamy Layer.
PwBD	Person with Benchmark Disability.
RRB	Railway Recruitment Board. There are 21, and you apply to exactly one.
RRC	Railway Recruitment Cell, which runs separate recruitments, usually for Level 1 posts.

This edition was compiled on 30 October 2026. It is a reading of the official notifications and of the Railway Recruitment Boards' own published cut-off notices. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or issued on behalf of the Railway Recruitment Boards, the Ministry of Railways or the Government of India. Always confirm dates, fees and eligibility on the official portal before you act.